

1-2 Stimulating Stakeholder Curiosity – Additional Resources

Fortunately, AI is a great tool for discovering resources to help stimulate curiosity in a project context.

As resources and AI tools improve, you may find even more resources using your favorite AI tool. Using Gemini, here is a prompt and the result:

Prompt: Provide a list of websites and other resources that include exercises to stimulate curiosity, particularly in the area of project requirements elicitation.

Result:

General Resources on Stimulating Curiosity:

Books:

“Curious? Discover the Missing Ingredient in Life” by Todd Kashdan: Explores the benefits of curiosity and how to cultivate it

“A More Beautiful Question” by Warren Berger: Focuses on the power of questioning in driving innovation and creativity

“Curious: The Desire to Know and Why Your Future Depends On It” by Ian Leslie: Examines the nature of curiosity and its importance in a changing world

“Range: Why Generalists Triumph in a Specialized World” by David Epstein: While not solely about curiosity, it highlights the value of diverse experiences and broad interests in fostering insightful thinking.

Articles and Blogs:

Learning Rebels: Offers insights on curiosity as a business practice, emphasizing open communication, collaboration, and questioning

<https://www.learningrebels.com/2021/09/07/curiosity-as-a-business-practice/>

BA Times: Discusses cultivating curiosity in business analysts, highlighting active listening, questioning assumptions, and embracing a growth mindset

<https://www.batimes.com/articles/cultivating-curiosity/>

Posit: Emphasizes the value of curiosity for data scientists and provides practical ways to cultivate a curious mind, such as making time for learning and asking good questions

<https://posit.co/blog/the-value-of-curiosity-and-how-to-cultivate-a-curious-mind/>

TeachHUB: Provides teaching strategies to promote critical thinking, which often involves stimulating curiosity through questioning and inquiry-based learning

<https://www.teachhub.com/teaching-strategies/2014/09/teaching-strategies-to-promote-critical-thinking/>

Serviam Partners: Focuses on cultivating curiosity as a skill, particularly in interpersonal interactions, emphasizing asking questions and showing genuine interest

<https://www.serviampartners.com/cultivating-curiosity-as-a-skill/>

Extraordinary Team: Offers strategies for cultivating curiosity within a team, such as encouraging questions, sharing learning, and modeling curious behavior

<https://extraordinaryteam.com/curiosity-in-your-team/>

Zanovoy: Discusses how fostering a culture of curiosity through asking the right questions can transform a business <https://www.zanovoy.com/blog-posts/cultivating-a-culture-of-curiosity-how-asking-the-right-questions-can-transform-your-business>

Resources with Exercises for Requirements Elicitation and Curiosity:

Creative Problem-Solving Techniques: Many creative problem-solving exercises can inherently stimulate curiosity by encouraging participants to think outside the box and explore different perspectives.

Brainstorming and Brainwriting: These techniques encourage generating a large number of ideas, fostering curiosity about potential solutions. (Future Processing)

Mind Mapping and Concept Mapping: Visualizing information and connections can spark curiosity about relationships between requirements and concepts. (Future Processing, UXPin)

Six Thinking Hats: This framework encourages looking at a problem from different perspectives (emotional, logical, creative, etc.), promoting curiosity about alternative viewpoints. (Future Processing, BA Times)

The Reversal Technique: Turning a problem on its head can lead to unexpected insights and fuel curiosity about unconventional solutions. (Future Processing)

SCAMPER: This acronym (Substitute, Combine, Adapt, Modify, Put to another use, Eliminate, Reverse) provides prompts to explore creative solutions and encourages a curious mindset towards existing elements. (UXPin)

Crazy 8s: A rapid ideation technique that pushes participants to quickly generate multiple ideas, fostering curiosity under time constraints. (UXPin)

Worst Possible Idea: Sometimes thinking of the worst solution can paradoxically spark curiosity about what might actually work. (UXPin)

Role-Playing: Stepping into the shoes of different stakeholders can foster empathy and curiosity about their needs and perspectives. (MoldStud, Modern Requirements)

Prototyping: Creating early versions of a product or feature allows stakeholders to interact and provide feedback, stimulating curiosity and uncovering hidden requirements. (Jama Software, Modern Requirements)

Observation (Active and Passive): Observing users in their natural environment can reveal unspoken needs and spark curiosity about their actual workflows. (Jama Software, Modern Requirements)

“Yes, and” exercises: Building on each other’s ideas without criticism can foster a more open and curious environment for exploring requirements. (Apolitical)

Alternate Use Pitches: Thinking about objects in unconventional ways can encourage a broader perspective on potential solutions and requirements. (Apolitical)

Websites and Articles Specific to Requirements Elicitation:

Bridging the Gap: Offers advice on becoming more confident in requirements elicitation, which includes preparing thoroughly and being present to understand stakeholder perspectives <https://www.bridging-the-gap.com/how-to-become-more-confident-in-requirements-elicitation-confidence/> While not solely exercises, the tips encourage a curious and investigative approach.

Modern Requirements: Provides a comprehensive guide to requirements gathering techniques, including brainstorming, focus groups, interviews, and surveys, all of which can be used in a way that stimulates curiosity through open-ended questions and exploration <https://www.modernrequirements.com/blogs/requirements-gathering-techniques/>

Jama Software: Offers a guide to requirements elicitation, highlighting the importance of understanding stakeholder needs and using various techniques like brainstorming and prototyping to uncover them <https://www.jamasoftware.com/requirements-management-guide/requirements-gathering-and-management-processes/a-guide-to-requirements-elicitation-for-product-teams/>

Agilemania: Presents an essential guide to requirement elicitation in business analysis, emphasizing the need to ask the right questions and use a variety of techniques to uncover stakeholder needs <https://agilemania.com/top-requirement-elicitation-techniques-in-business-analysis>

Future Processing Blog: Discusses creative techniques in the requirements elicitation process, such as brainwriting, mind mapping, and the Six Thinking Hats, which are designed to foster innovative thinking and explore requirements from different angles <https://www.future-processing.com/blog/creative-techniques-in-the-requirements-elicitation-process/>

MoldStud: Emphasizes the importance of empathy in requirements gathering and suggests techniques like role-playing and active listening to better understand stakeholder needs and uncover underlying requirements <https://moldstud.com/articles/p-the-importance-of-empathy-in-requirements-elicitation-for-business-analysts>

By exploring these resources and incorporating the suggested exercises and techniques, individuals and teams can enhance their curiosity and improve their effectiveness in project requirements elicitation. Remember that fostering curiosity is an ongoing process that requires conscious effort and a willingness to explore different perspectives.